

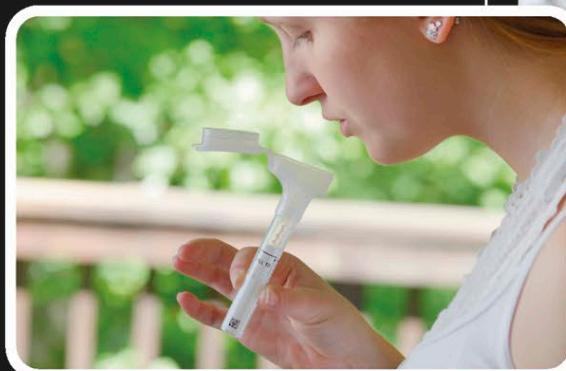
IDENTIFYING CRIMINALS

DNA ANALYSIS

Forensics is the use of science to work out what happened at the scene of a crime. Forensic scientists study many different types of evidence, such as traces of blood, fingerprints, footprints, and other marks. They are also able to analyze DNA—the set of genetic instructions we all contain. Every person's DNA is unique (apart from that of identical twins). It is found in almost every cell of our body, so we easily lose bits by shedding flakes of skin and hairs or by losing blood.

GENETIC TESTING

DNA testing is not just useful for the police. Home DNA testing kits use a person's spit to extract their DNA, allowing people to find out who they are related to and their wider ancestry. Doctors also use genetic tests to look for the causes of diseases.



DNA

DNA—short for deoxyribonucleic acid—is like a biological bar code, a unique recipe for making each one of us who we are. It is found inside cells of the body, in the nucleus—a cell's control center—and has a ladder-shaped structure called a double helix. The “rungs” of the ladder are made up of four different chemicals called bases, shown here in different colors.

